A

About 300 million years ago, the Earth was covered in lots of vegetation.	Dead plants fell into swampy water and the mud prevented them from rotting away.	Over the years, the mud piled up and squashed the plant remains.	After millions of years under pressure, the mud became rock and the plants became coal.

B

Millions of years ago tiny animals lived in the sea.	When they died they fell into mud and sand at the bottom of the sea but did not rot away.	Over millions of years, the animal remains were buried deeper by the mud and sand.	The pressure changed the mud and sand into rock. The dead animals turned into crude oil and natural gas.

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Teaching notes

Cut up the cards before the lesson. Give each pair a set of cards (you could give them both sets together or one at a time depending on ability). The students need to match each card with a picture and put them in the correct sequence.

Follow on activity

Students could work in small groups to produce a presentation, short play, song or poem to demonstrate how one of the fossil fuels is made.

They should include:

- a description of how the fossil fuel is formed
- an explanation of how the fossil fuel is formed
- how energy is transformed during the process
- uses of the fossil fuel
- advantages and disadvantages of the fossil fuel.

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